DATASCI507: Proposal

Jozef Rivest

November 5, 2026

Abstract

Placeholder

1 Introduction

Can political bulletins tell us something about party's level of centralization?

2 Theory

The setup goes as follow. A national party i seeks to gain as much votes as possible in order to win an election. To achieve this, it has to convince the local population across the whole country to i) turnout on the day of the election, and ii) vote for party i. To do this, the party dispose of resources which it can allocates across the different constituencies to help promote certain candidates. The party i also needs to decide how *discretionary* its candidates can be in their campaign. For simplicity, we will treat the allocation of resources as fixed for this model, and focus exclusively on the *centralization* choice of party i.

The problem about centralization goes as follow. The leader of party i does not know about the local needs and issues of all the constituencies. Therefore, by imposing a low discretionary power to the candidates running for its party, he runs the risk to alineate part of the electorate. His priorities might be situated far from those of the local population in constituency d.

3 Data

This project collects an original data set using political bulletins in Japan for the 2021, 2024, 2026 lower house elections.